

QA LAB BRASIL

Reference guide - QA Lab Brasil

Incidents, RCA and Postmortems

Triage, mitigation, resolution, Root Cause Analysis and learning after production issues.

Defect vs incident

A defect is an imperfection in the product. An incident is an event that degrades or interrupts a service. A defect may cause an incident, but the terms are not equivalent.

Triage and mitigation

During an incident, prioritize impact, affected users, service, timing, evidence and mitigation. Restoring user experience may come before finding root cause.

RCA — Root Cause Analysis

5 Whys, Ishikawa and evidence analysis can support investigation. Avoid ending RCA with only “human error”; look for systemic conditions that allowed the problem.

Postmortem

Document impact, timeline, cause, detection, response and preventive actions. The goal is learning and improving the system and process.

QA Tip: A good postmortem turns an incident into verifiable actions with owners and follow-up.